

RPT Exporter

Prerequisites

Minimum System Requirements

- Windows 10
- Intel Core i5-6500 Processor @ 3.60 GHz
- 4GB RAM
- 4MB Disk Space

.NET 4.8 Runtime x86

Note that Windows 11 and later versions of Windows 10 come with this framework pre-installed.

Crystal Reports .NET Runtime x86

Note that runtime version 13.0 has been tested with RPT files designed on Crystal Reports XI R2 SP6, but SAP maintains a high degree of backwards compatibility with their products, so any version of their .NET runtime should work.

Whichever version is used, only the 32-bit (x86) runtime is supported by the RPT Exporter application.

Installation

Copy the RPT Exporter application directory into the directory that holds the Bridge Manager client executable.

On startup, the Bridge Manager client application searches its starting directory for “RPT Exporter/RPT Exporter.exe”. If it finds it, it will add an RPT Exporter button to the Database menu in its title bar. You may launch the RPT Exporter from here, or from a shortcut directly to the executable.

Future Updates

Due to the rudimentary nature of the installation, updates follow a similar process. Simply overwrite the current installation with a folder holding the latest version of RPT Exporter.

RPT Exporter must be closed before attempting the update.

An Important Note on Licensing

The Crystal Reports designer requires a separate licence for each installed copy. The Crystal Reports runtime, however, is licence-free, so long as it is not used to edit or otherwise manipulate the RPT files it works with. RPT Exporter has been designed to work with RPT files without adjusting the file data in any way in order to preserve the legality of having it installed on multiple machines.

Loading RPT Files

RPT files are the report files generated by the Crystal Reports designer.

When running RPT Exporter, You will notice a Directory button. Click it, then point the application to the directory holding the RPT files you wish to read.

If any are found, they will be listed in the main window. Either click on one and then click Export, or simply double-click one of the files.

If any parameters are required, you will be asked for them now. Input values as desired, then click Export. After selecting a save location, your system's default PDF viewer will now load and display the output.

Crystal Reports Designer Notes

Exclude Report Data from File

In Crystal Reports designer, before saving the RPT file, uncheck the "Save Data with Report" box (where this is and if it's named something slightly different will be dependent on the version of Crystal Reports). This is not strictly necessary, but it is recommended to reduce file sizes.

Supported Parameter Types

Currently, the following types are supported by RPT Exporter for use with parameters:

- Text *
- Number
- Date
- Date & Time
- Time
- Boolean

* Text parameters can be set up to display as a dropdown list or as checkboxes if desired. In Crystal Reports Designer, set the text parameter to use only a predefined list of values, and enable multi-select to have the input display as a checkbox list as opposed to a dropdown list.